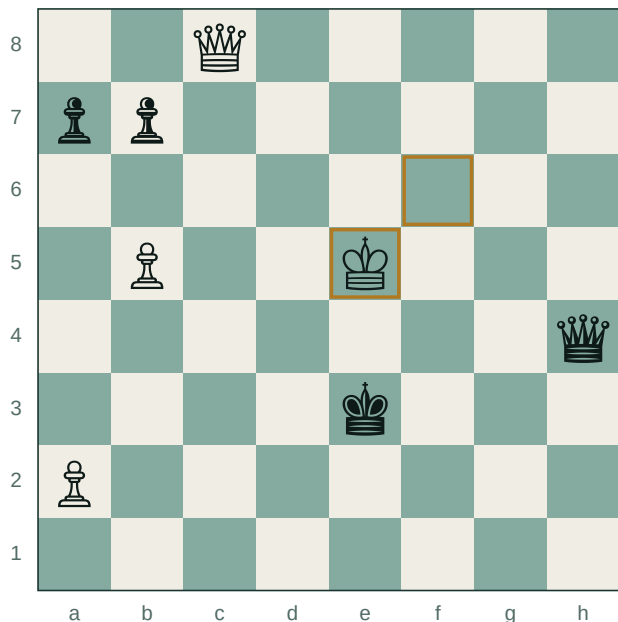


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 44

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 44.Ke5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

44...Qf4+ 45. Kd5 Qd4+ 46. Ke6 Qg4+ 47. Ke7 Qxc8

44...Qf4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **45.Kd5**.

45...Qd4+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **46.Ke6**.

46...Qg4+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **47.Ke7**.

47...Qxc8 The queen captures the queen on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from +0 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on e5. Geometrically undefended: queen on c8. Check for tactical protection.